

The compact car

- **What?** BMC Mini
- **Who?** Alec Issigonis
- **When?** UK, 1959

The Mini was one of the first successful tiny cars designed for the city. It saved space by mounting

the engine sideways and using front-wheel drive, not back. This idea proved so good that now most small cars are made like this.

BMC Austin Seven Mini



Electric car

- **What?** Tesla Roadster
- **Who?** Martin Eberhard and Marc Tarpenning
- **Where and when?** US, 2008

Cars that use gasoline and diesel produce air and noise pollution. So, in 2008, the American car company Tesla revived the idea of the electric car with the Roadster, their stylish sports car. Though these cars do not use gasoline or diesel, they can take a long time to recharge after each trip. Electric cars are better for the environment.

Driverless car

- **What?** Audi A8 L
- **Who?** Audi
- **Where and when?** Germany, 2017

An autonomous, or driverless, car can sense its environment and steer without a human driver, using radar, lasers, and GPS (see p.265) to “see” where it is going. The



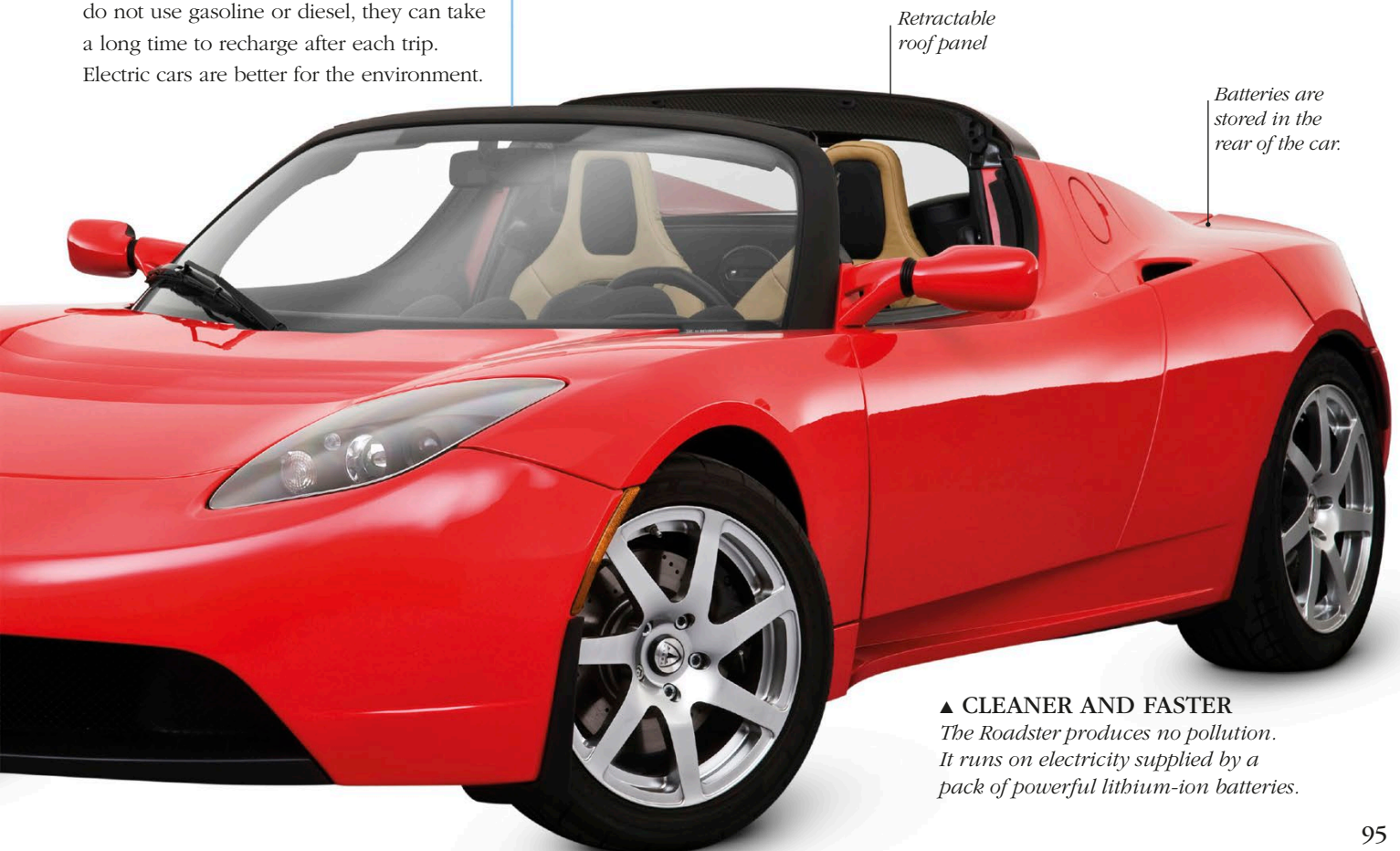
Hybrid

- **What?** Toyota Prius
- **Who?** Toyota
- **Where and when?** Japan, 1997

A hybrid car has both a battery-powered electric motor and a fuel-powered engine. The electric motor powers the car whenever it is fully charged, but the car can also run on the fuel engine. The first successful commercially available hybrid car was the Toyota Prius, which was introduced in 1997.



Audi A8 L is the first fully driverless car to go into production. It can drive for long distances, brake, and even park on its own.



▲ **CLEANER AND FASTER**
The Roadster produces no pollution. It runs on electricity supplied by a pack of powerful lithium-ion batteries.